Notice of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (October 22, 2026 Issue)

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Subject: Notice of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (October 22, 2026 Issue)

Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are providing you with the latest information on regional and analysis reports that JETRO produces from its unique perspective on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these useful.

Member email newsletters had been suspended due to website downtime, but we are gradually resuming distribution following the website's restoration.

The newsletters being resumed are the following three types:
• "Regional and Analysis Reports" for JM members
• "Food & Agriculture Reports" (reports and event information in the agriculture, forestry, fisheries, and food sectors)
• "JETRO Members News" (event and information announcements for JM members)

Regarding the "JETRO Business Brief" whose distribution resumed yesterday, there was a malfunction where article links were not displayed. We sincerely apologize for any inconvenience caused. The relevant department has corrected the issue and will redistribute with an apology.

◆Contents◆

【Special Feature】Diversifying Consumer Profiles in Asia-Pacific
—Decoding Values, Lifestyles, and Market Opportunities— ＜Additional Articles＞

In the Asia-Pacific region, consumer needs and purchasing behaviors are becoming increasingly diverse against the backdrop of rising incomes, urbanization, and digitalization. While these changes vary by country, common trends are also emerging. This special feature addresses market trends in major ASEAN countries, India, and Bangladesh, and analyzes what consumers value, their consumption characteristics, and the factors influencing their purchasing decisions, alongside case studies of Japanese companies operating locally. By cross-referencing cases across countries and sectors, we explore market opportunities and business expansion hints for Japanese companies.

＜Additional Articles＞
◇Indonesia (2) Eating Habits and Prices Shape the Ready-to-Eat Food Market
◇Indonesia (3) Affordability and Taste Support Confectionery; Growing Health Consciousness
◇Malaysia (1) Understanding Consumers Through Market Environment, Values, and Culture

◇Malaysia (2) Consumer Markets Where Online and Offline Converge
◇Philippines (1) Focus on Trust, Value, and Connection
◇Philippines (2) Understanding Consumers Through "Food"
◇Thailand (4) "Wanting to Help" Sustains Thailand's Rescue Cat Cafes
◇India (1) New Trends Led by Middle-Class Expansion and Digitalization
◇India (2) Localization and Differentiation in the Household Air Conditioning Market

【Special Feature】Sustainable Packaging and Corporate Response Cases ＜Additional Articles＞

Globally, various regulations and voluntary initiatives are being implemented for containers and packaging to reduce waste and promote recycling or reuse. The EU's "Packaging and Packaging Waste Regulation (PPWR)" enforced in 2025 mandates that packaging be recyclable at certain rates and requires the use of recycled materials in plastic packaging. Even in regions without regulations like the EU's, companies may face demands from global trading partners and overseas retailers to change packaging or use materials that are easier to recycle. This special feature focuses on global sustainable packaging regulations, packaging-related companies, and company case studies using such packaging, providing concrete ideas for companies seeking to address sustainable packaging.

＜Additional Articles＞
◇Dcycle Centralizes PPWR Packaging Data Using AI (EU)

【Special Feature】Leading Universities Producing Highly Skilled Foreign Talent
＜Additional Articles＞

In recent years, Japan's talent recruitment market remains a seller's market. Science and engineering talent shortages are particularly severe, and companies are increasingly looking to foreign workers. Meanwhile, approximately 70% of international students in Japan are liberal arts majors, with few in science and engineering. In this context, interest is also growing in international students studying science and engineering in English and science and engineering talent enrolled in overseas universities. Additionally, more companies are hoping to hire students from overseas universities who study Japanese, regardless of major. This special feature, based on interviews with promising domestic and international universities producing science and engineering talent and Japanese language learners interested in working in Japan, introduces distinctive curricula, employment situations at Japanese companies, and messages to companies.

＜Additional Articles＞
◇"International Exchange and Regional